The Sun and the Sea

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/63064708.

Rating:
General Audiences

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Creator Chose Not To Use Archive Warnings

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F/F

Fandom:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

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Adora/Catra (She-Ra)

Characters:
Adora (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra)

Additional Tags:
Extra: Anchor, Post main events, happy valentines day, Set a year after the main events of the story, You´ll need to read Anchor first to understand, Writer Catra, Human Catra, Siren Adora, Mythical Beings & Creatures, Mentions of Myth & Folklore, domestic life, Fluff, Mild Hurt/Comfort, Happy, Mentions of Past ED, Eating Disorder Not Otherwise Specified, Mentions of PTSD, Body Worship, Body Positivity, Healing, Weddings

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Part 2 of The Sea and the Sun

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The Sun and the Sea

by StarryNap

Summary

A year after the main events of Anchor, Adora looks at the life she has built with Catra and fights the memories of the past that still weigh over both of them. The path to healingis not lineal but they are getting there and they love each other

or

First Extra Short Story for Anchor. Happy Valentines Day [remember you´ll need to read Anchor first to understand]

Notes

Hi! So glad to have you, lovers of the sea, back in this little beautiful world full of sirens, magic and love.

Anchor ended a little bit more than a year ago and the nostalgia has weighed heavy over me. This is possibly my most cherished story and I have missed these two beautiful girls with all my heart.

So, for Valentines Day this year I decided to write a very short story set a few days before out girls get marry. Hope you enjoy the trip and be assured I will be writting a few more extra shorts for them.

Without more to say, enjoy :3

See the end of the work for more notes

The Sun and the Sea

The angels up in the clouds are jealous knowing we found

Something so out of the ordinary

You got me kissing the ground of your sanctuary

Shatter me with your touch, oh Lord, return me to dust

The angels up in the clouds are jealous knowing we found

— *Ordinary,* **Alex Warren**

—— ⋆·☆·⋆ ——

It's nighttime in the human world but here, in the depths of the ocean, the pass of the sun on the sky doesn't really matter.

Adora blinks at the neon darkness all around her, the thin membrane that covers her eyes instead of eyelids shivering a little under the touch of heavy salt and pressure. It's nice, like a feather.

There are animals crawling over her where she lies on the ocean floor, little creatures making their ways up and down her arms and neck and forehead, tangling their legs on the strands of her seaweed and silk hair.

They are unafraid of her, and this Adora likes. They don't care about her sharp teeth crawling on the insides of her mouth, or about her poisonous thorns crowning her temples and elbows. They don't care about the turquoise or amber of her scales or about the acid lingering in her eyes. They don't care and even if they do their curiosity is bigger than their reason.

Adora likes curious things, she herself is a curious thing from the ocean so she is deeply fond of all things shivering and all things searching for new weird crevices of the world. She thumbs over

the crabs and the starfish and even the shells chomping around over her skin and laughs when the shrimps and fish swim by her face without even looking back.

Adora likes when curious critters walk over her in land too. She likes the itty bitty spiders, the ants and the beetles and the moths in the meadows of her home. She likes the fireflies and the worms on her bare feet and even the biting mosquitoes leaving bruises on her marble skin.

She wonders just exactly how she looks for them. Tall, broad, sharp. Bright and golden, blinking with impossible eyes, staring at the world in marble and at these infinite small creatures with her dimples curled into a smile. Like a giant maybe or just an incredibly weird star in the day sky.

Maybe she has gone soft, with time, with the months and the year, maybe even them know she is less dangerous now. Lethal still, Apex predator, daughter of the sea. But sweeter, more tender, less hungry for the hunt and craving more for the clouds. It would be fitting because Adora is all of that now.

Right now, however, it is time for her to shake from the tiny grains of sand and the tinier critters making nests in her hair and swirl from the floor of the ocean, following the gentle light of the moon above her in a known path. She has been here the whole day and the ocean has welcomed her back like every day, but now she just wants to go home.

Her long tail lashes against the water, easily cutting her way through its density, swirling up and up and following the thin silver rays melting with her hair. Her fine ears flicker a little as she catches all the sounds around her, all the little echoes and mysterious shivering that are the ocean's alone. And also other kinds of sounds, of stones rolling over sand and curtains against open window frames.

Adora feels the change of pressure as she reaches the surface, the colorful ocean lighter and lighter everywhere, familiar and

tender like an old home.Everywhere except in the tall wall of stone next to her. She tries to ignore it completely but she cannot help the shiver that travels through her entire body at the feeling of it hovering over her like an impossible shadow, unyielding as it closes its long claw over her heart.

Thorn and poison and teeth and all, after so many months and no matter what, this single shadow still weighs inside Adora's skin and bones like a curse.

The surface welcomes her with a deep breath of air, the warm air of the early night curling the hairs around her ears and the back of her neck. It's a calm night for the ocean, the moon new and the waves gentle all around her. A calm night on a calm shore where sorrow or fear knows no place anymore.

She swims towards the line where the ocean meets the sand, refusing to look back as she steps into the precarious floor and steps out of her skin. The soft material falls in her hands and elbows, brushing the human angle of her ankles as she steps fully on this shore, her shore, white sand and dark pebbles and sea glass rolling below her soles.

The water is just a little bit cold when she changes fully into her human form, waving goodbye at her for tonight before retreating back into its immense expanse, dark blue and shimmering with the reflection of stars just above the night sky. Adora hums softly at it, feeling the water in her skin and veins curl inside her very heart and make a nest there.

The skin keeps her warm as she walks over the shore and into the pebbled path, tip-toeing over the loose stones she knows from heart by now. Her hair is long too, longer than it has ever been before, curling well past her human waist and hips, bouncing slowly against the back of her thighs. It melts a little with the colors of the skin, golden among the blues and the ambers and the copper, strands of starlight that remain braided on the sides even after hours in the salted water.

And she smells heavily like the ocean, this Adora knows as she walks up the two steps of the porch, feeling in her toes the familiar wood of the house and hearing the twinkle of the windchimes in the roof. She does not smell like seaweed or fish but something deeper, something different that is the ocean alone and also Adora´s, as she is her daughter. Something that sometimes Adora loves to say is a little bit like deeping your hands into a galaxy and smelling the magic nuzzling out of it.

The lights are on in the house next to the shore, as they always are when Adora comes back home. There has been not a single day of darkness inside these new yet long old walls, not from the moment they stepped together back to the place that had seen them fall in love and then turn part. That had seen them reunited and held into each other and never let go again.

There is always a lamp on, sometimes a chandelier or a single night lamp but never a candle alone because the fire is still too much. On most nights the chimney is on and so is the kitchen and the greenhouse, and the round window of the upper floor, washing golden light on the white shore. It shows Adora the way, just in case she ever gets lost.

Even before she steps fully inside, she can smell it, smell her house and all those little accents that make it theirs. She can smell it because the window of the love seat is slightly ajar as it always is, never closed again, and the main door has been left open, never familiar with the fear of darkness bursting in ever again.

Adora rests her long and pale palm over the blue wood and pushes it just slightly to the side, slipping inside calmly before closing it back behind her. She knows darkness is gone but she needs the safety of the closed space behind her back, just for tonight.

The house is warm and it is lovely, as it has been every single day after the war and the healing, as it will be every day from now on. The lights of the kitchen are on, warm and orange over the floor

and the fireplace cracks every once in a while in the living room,filling every single corner of this place with tenderness.

Melog is curled next to the latter, their little head rising a little from their pillow when they catch Adora coming inside. Their huge blue eyes dilate like moonlights at the sight of her and they greet her with a soft purr before coming back to their nap. Adora smiles at them back, quiet through it all but easy.

The weight over her heart lifts a little the further she walks inside, warming her feet in the carpet and roaming sea glass eyes over every room of the floor, taking in the sight of a house that is here to be called hers. The small door in the kitchen that leads to the greenhouse has been forgotten open, letting see through the big and small baskets already filled with sweet harvest for tomorrow ´s market. The green leaves and colorful blooms that Adora´s love has been so carefully taking care of have not stopped sprouting not even once and thinks it's fitting because even the earth must love her too.

The smell is stronger now, guiding Adora to the kitchen, with flowers on the counter and clean from the cooking except for one single plate and silver fork, placed with love and waiting for Adora to return.

It´s a piece of peach pie, pretty, the crust golden and the sugary fruit glistening with caramel. Vanilla ice cream sits at the top, crowned by mint leaf and Adora knows it has just been left here because it has barely started to melt, just waiting for the moment when Adora would be ready to return.

It´s not the only thing that has been made here, on this golden place with wood furniture and colorful mosaic. It smells like freshly baked bread, resting its heat near the closed stove. There are traces of olive dipped cheese in the air, followed by lemon zest and oranges, coconut and strawberries. Preserves waiting in the cupboard for the moment to be stored.

There are chocolate chips sprinkled with sea salt and caramel in the jar that Adora knows are for her; crumbling sfogliatella, homemade cheese and even blueberry and whiskey cake. So many little things, ready to be eaten in incoming day and to be given to friends, all of them gentle testimonies of a journey towards healing that Adora is grateful for, that sometimes make her want to laugh. That kind you give right after you cry and the world is a little bit brighter in the edges.

For now she takes the fine plate and comes to sit in the spot on the carpet next to Melog, enjoying their gentle purr as she bites into the sweet flavor of peach melting into her tongue. Her skin pools softly below her back and over her legs, keeping her warm. She could change into the soft pair of freshly washed joggers and shirt in the laundry but she likes the liberty of being herself inside her own home, enjoying food that has been made from the heart for her to eat and not from the hunt.

Adora can feel water running gently in the room above her head, falling like a small cascade against a clean mosaic, the heat of the steam clear even against Adora´s cheeks. A shower, warm and relaxing after a day of a quiet life, meant to make the muscles tender again and the head sleepy. Adora gives a sigh at the sound and eats calmly, waiting next to the golden and blue flames of the logs until she hears the run of water running into a stop.

Adora rises back to her feet with a small sprint in her step, walking the steps towards the stairs and climbing them all the way to their shared room. She does not run or rush but there is a kind of urgency to her sprint that matches the one that has been curling inside her bones for a few days now, moving her forwards and forwards until she is face to face to the door of the bedroom and she pushes it gently open, stepping inside in silence.

Catra is standing in front of the vanity, her back towards the door, toweling the rest of the damp and the steam off her neck and shoulders. She is bare from head to toe, humming pleasantly with her eyes closed. And she smells good, like the lavender soap they share and clean breeze and something so much hers that it makes

Adora´s head dizzy the second it swirls inside her nose and mouth.

Like this, the towel lingering in the small of her waist and her feet bare, Adora can see the expanse of Catra´s body, her sun freckles like stars over a copper sky. Like this, Adora can see the little divot of her spine against her skin, The soft fall of her skin against her hips, the extension of her arms and the gentle swell of her breasts,

And the scars. One by one, small and big and overpowering sometimes, cradled with opal scales and sea glass that make her look like she stepped off the stained glass in the window. Precious, keeping her alive, but testimonies of pain after all. Adora loves them because they belong to Catra and Adora loves everything about her, all of her, but goddess above, they still ache.

Catra does not see Adora walk in but there must be a sound or a change in the air, or maybe her heart and her soul is so woven to Adora´s that she knows the minute she steps inside that she is there, because without stop humming she turns around with a smile already curling the dimple in her cheek, opening her eyes like one would greet a morning sun.

"Hey, my love," Catra says, so soft is a whisper and almost a song. She is not surprised to see her there, she never is. Catra regards Adora standing in the frame of the door with her skin tangled in her arms and legs, and her eyes melt, tenderness and adoration overflowing off her like a sea of herself. "I saw you coming from the window"

Adora has come to know herself, little by little in these months that turned into a year. To not only know about the siren lashing in the middle of unreachable waters but about *Adora,* bare feet on land and breeze on her hair. And with this knowledge has come tenderness, and with this tenderness has come Catra, who is everything good inside Adora´s world.

Catra is still looking at Adora in silence, waiting for her to catch up. There is an amused grin in the corner of her lips but there is also a kind of wise look in her colorful eyes that tell Adora that Catra just knows that things are just a little bit different today, a little more heavier and sorrowful, and so she waits for Adora. She always does, no matter how long Adora dives into the ocean, Catra is always there, she always knows so she is always ready to welcome her back.

Adora exhales, blinking several times, so much that she feels the tears gathering in her eyes and tethering in the edge of her eyelashes. They might even fall, leaving traces on her skin like star trails.

Her skin is still pooled inside her arms when she starts walking the small distance that separates her from the other half of her soul, dragging sea glass and pearl and turquoise in the ground until she reaches her. Adora wraps Catra inside her arms and sighs, relief slipping inside her bones at the feeling of Catra´s skin against hers once again. Adora has been in the sea for barely a day but even then the distance was unbearable today.

Adora cradles Catra´s face inside her palms and leans her forehead against hers, closing her eyes at the feeling of their bodies meeting, different kinds of kisses in all the ways that matter. She cannot even help when her eyelids flutter and fall closed, drinking in everything that Catra is now that she has her inside the safety of her arms.

Catra doesn´t seem to notice that Adora´s entire world is spinning, or maybe she does and chooses not to press in the matter. She sighs too, resting her hands against Adora´s ribs, caressing the tender scales that sprout and live there with careful fingers. She is always so careful with Adora´s body, so quiet and happy and joyful. As if now that she has been granted the privilege of a gentle life, she wanted to drink in the light of it completely.

Catra hums, nuzzling the side of Adora´s jaw into a gentle siren kiss. She is merry, this Adora can tell easily; Catra is happy and calm today, pleased by the orange smell still lingering in her skin and her hands tired from rolling dough. She is like a song all in herself, little pieces of piano and flute and violin and voice, skipping through this life in verses. Like sitting in the window of their home and hearing the seafoam turn into sand and salt. Like a giggle in the middle of the night. Like a flower in a meadow and stones paths smooth by the tide.

She is copper and sun in Adora´s pale blue hands; full of life, little by little, like pieces of a puzzle. As if the sky and the earth themselves had made her from soil and stardust. She is alive and fluttering, constant and mortal; silent like the fabric of the universe and joyful like a burning galaxy.

She is everything Adora ever loved, with her devotion immense like the ocean and her heart beating like the marshes. She is everything Adora ever dreamed and wished for, thread around her finger and hope for tenderness. Sharpness melted like liquid gold, sword to ring. She is everything she missed, everything she holds dear, all of it inside this body scattered in freckles. It lives in the arch of her soles and the thinness of her fingers; in the waves of her hair brushing her chin and the depths of her knees and the fall of her collarbones. It lives on her tears and her sweat and her breath like water, calling Adora home.

Catra giggles next to Adora´s fluttering ears, smiles over her skin and rests over her pearl scales, resting her body and soul in Adora ´s hands because she knows she will be safe there.

“You smell nice,” she whispers, running her fingertips over golden hair, lighter now that the cold of the year has made the ocean gentler.

Adora wants to answer back, she wants to sing and to profess her adoration back to her but she finds that she can´t. That her words are tangled in her human vocal cords and her heart is seized and she can´t. She can´t break this peaceful silence, she cannot

mingle her voice now. She wants to hear Catra´s breath inside her ears and feel her voice around her heart, but Adora cannot speak.

"What is it?" Catra asks softly, searching for Adora´s colorful eyes when she realizes the kind of silence that envelops them now.

Adora does not refuse her sight, she has not done that in a long time and she will never do it again, so Catra sees the answers to her question fully inside the ocean blue of Adora´s irises, some kind of knowledge setting in her chest.

"I see," Catra whispers, her mouth curling into a grin, her eyes kind. She knows. "Is it a quiet day?"

There have been plenty of quiet days for them in the past months, in the past year. It has been a part of healing and some of them were terrible, heavy, almost unbearable, but not all of them were bad. With time, they got better at understanding when a silence was needed, when it was seeked for. When one or both of them needed a second, just one long second to breathe.

Adora nods slowly, lips closed. Yes, there have been plenty of silences. This is one of them, tonight, but it is the kind that is gentle, the kind that doesn´t ache in the bone but that soothes them. Talking is painful but remaining quiet is a mercy and Adora lingers into it, safe in Catra´s understatement.

Catra caresses a gentle line over Adora´s cheekbone and nods, bringing her hands in front of Adora´s face. She signs slowly, sure and practiced, gentle enough that Adora can read the words and absorb them inside her chest. Catra´s elegant hand tapping once over the open palm of her other twice.

" *It´s alright,* " she signs, smiling. If Adora is quiet then she can be quiet too. " *I got you"*

Of course she does. She is Adora's entire heart.

Adora exhales, brushing the back of her knuckles over Catra's rose pink cheeks. She is warm like the tides that brought Adora here for the first time, gentle, body soft and covered in kisses that wash away scars.

"I need to hold you" Adora signs, thumbing the corner of Catra's eye right after. There are new freckles in her cheeks, after summer and winter, gentle brown over dark skin.

" *That would be very nice* " Catra smiles, she has not stopped smiling not even once. " *Do you want me to dress?"*

" *No,"* Adora nibbles on her lip, thinking about the possible understandment of her words as pink dust paints over her cheeks *. "It's not about sex, it's just– I need you"*

Catra is very patient and she is very sweet, she already knows what Adora means.

"You have me," she reassures her in a murmur, tucking Adora´s golden hair behind her crystal ear.

Adora´s skin pools between both of them, traces of starlight brushing both of their bare bodies. Adora sighs quietly and moves, gathering in her fingers and draping it over her own chest as she wraps her arms around Catra´s waist, holding her dearly next to her chest. The skin seeks for Catra just as much as it seeks for Adora, feeling her in the traces of sea glass and grains of sand, sticking to her hips and waist and the fall of her shoulders.

Holding her breath and then up and now Adora is carrying Catra inside her embrace, guiding them both to their soft bed, below the fine fabric of the canopy hanging above blue sheets and white wool. Catra giggles against Adora´s cold lips, kicking her feet lightly against Adora´s knees when she feels her body parting from the ground. She rests her forearms over Adora´s shoulders and nuzzles her cheek over Adora´s forehead, trusting she will keep her up towards the sky, that she won´t let her fall.

They tumble inside the bed swiftly, practiced motions of a small lifetime of embracing each other this way and many others. Soft blankets are pulled aside and pillows moved to the side.

Catra moves softly up the bed, her feet catching in the sheets and making her giggle endearingly when she tries to kick herself free. She smells like peach pie too and something sweeter, food that nurtures and keeps her healthy still in her cells, free for Adora to smell and place, relieving like rain.

Adora grabs the gentle arch of her ankle inside her palm and leans down to press a kiss over the skin of her sole, worshiping the bone in the sides and the skin above with fluttering lips.

She follows an invisible trail up, rolling kisses like caresses all the way over her legs and calves, the secret side behind her knee and the freckled skin of her thighs, lingering in the place where her waist meets her belly button and beyond.

Catra shivers under the recent touch, sighing as her eyes roll inside their sockets and she has to bite into her bottom lip to keep the hum inside her chest.

Adora continues her travel with hooded eyes, wrapping her strong arms behind Catra's shoulder blades where wings might actually sprout any second now. She seeks for the swell of Catra's tender breasts and the hollow of her collarbones and finally her cheek, kissing her sweetly from the corner or her mouth to her temples until they are both out of breath.

Catra is still trying to make a cocoon out of their bed but Adora has been away from her for way too long now and she cannot help herself when she moves forward. She takes her skin and makes it fall softly over her own body once more, sticking to her limbs and neck and heart and making her anew again.

Long wings sprout from her face like traces of angels or birds, curling around her cheeks and cradling her nape and neck where they flutter with the relief of stretching free. They are dark but

they are also bright, sparkling with nebulas over ethereal feathers that cast golden shimmer between them.

Feathers and scales and pearls sprout across the length of her arms, feathers long too, so long she might just take flight yet she remains right here, nuzzled in Catra´s nest. They brush the curve of her calves and caress Catra´s soles where they rest over the mattress, like a tail all of their own but in a different way, wrapping themselves around Catra´s knees and thighs and holding her close.

Thorns rip away from Adora´s spine, stretching, raising and then falling once again, flat against her broad back and slim waist, keeping their poisonous tips away from where Catra slides her gentle palms over the fine membranes.

Scales and sea glass fall between her fingertips and curl like a cover of jade and quartz around her nails, long, deathly, cradling the side of Catra´s jaw and neck so gently it´s like a sword falling against a petal rose.

All of her eyes blink, bright like galaxies and nebulas, looking at Catra under this ethereal vision, watching her swirling in colors. Catra is golden with these eyes, with these irises. She is golden and warm, freckles like kisses, cheeks like flowers, dark hair braided in strands of starlight. Her skin is scattered in moles and in sea glass too, below the shallow of her breaths and the rise and fall of her ribs, bare for Adora to caress and guard.

Horns like coral reef curl from her temples and towards the back of her nape, tangling the golden strands of her hair and tinting it back into sea blue, so dark she might as well have brought the tides with her when she climbed from the waves to her wife´s bed.

Below her, resting over white pillows and silk sheets, Catra´s pupils blow up like moons, overtaking the colors of her eyes in eclipses. Her cheeks tint in red and her mouth falls open, another kind of light shimmering in her face, one that speaks of

undeniable adoration and devotion, no matter how many times she sees Adora like this inside her hands. Adora´s fine ears can pick up the rapid beating of Catra´s hummingbird heart, drumming inside her mortal chest with all the ocean´s strength.

"Oh, hey there," Catra gasps, in awe, pressing the pads of her fingers over the impossible swirls in Adora´s face, where she knows cheekbones live and she feels Adora´s pulse point shivering under the touch. "Pretty, pretty siren"

Adora exhales, her breath sweet and enticing even, specks of sweetness that stick to Catra´s nose and make her soft and relaxed, blinking very slowly as sleepiness starts to make its way inside her bones. Adora looks at her without moving for a second and hums, her song echoing in the depths of their bed and the corners of their room, filling their home and their shore with the safety of a sea goddess nestling in land.

The wings around Adora´s face flutter and close forwards, all of her feathers and scales falling around Catra´s body, cradling her face and neck, wrapping around her limbs and waist, knitting itself around her body. It wraps Catra into her own kind of nebula, protected, kept in a place different to the mortal world over her warm bed.

Adora´s legs slip forward, mortal limbs instead of sea tail, land legs and feet painted in dark and covered in their own sea glass, tangling themselves around Catra´s limbs. Soft and known until Catra´s warm soles rest above Adora´s calves and the low of her back.

Adora rests her weight over her body, careful of not crushing her down, of robbing the breath from her lungs or straining her ribs but there, chest to chest. Adora´s belly against Catra´s navel, breasts against her ribs, heart to heart beating at the same time.

Adora can see the way Catra´s breath shutters and hiccups inside her chest, the way she can feel her alive against her. The way she can feel her sighing when Adora nuzzles her face against her

pulse point and tangles their fingers together, refusing to let go of each other.

“Adora,” Catra hums, very very softly, running the fingers of her free hand across Adora´s feathers. “Do you know how much I love you?”

Adora shivers inside her arms, her impossible eyes watering. It is rare for Adora, this, becoming her full self just small enough to fit inside the bed of her lover. It is not always that she lets her human body melt alongside the ocean and rest like a tide over Catra. It has happened before, now that they are safe back in their home. Lovingly and tenderly and heated too but never like this, quietly.

Like this Adora can feel Catra´s life everywhere, from the tip of her toes to the roots of her soul, breathing into this world, safe and healing. Loving, a loving person loving everything about Adora, even the terrifying, even the terrible, even the monstrous. All of it.

“You certainly don't,” Catra answers for her, feeling Adora´s heart inside her own. She knows. Catra leans her pink mouth over the corner of Adora´s eyes and lingers her lips there into a whisper, said in secrecy. “Every second with you is a gift”

I love you, Adora thinks, so loud inside her head that she thinks it echoes too in the space between their bodies. *I adore you profoundly.*

She thinks that Catra also knows that, she hopes so with all her heart that Catra knows how much Adora loves her.

Catra is sleepy, drowsy, already halfway asleep inside Adora´s embrace. She nuzzles on their shared touch and the pillow and drifts into the arms of sleep, cooed by Adora´s song. Adora watches her in silence, the way her eyes grow drowsy as she looks up at Adora´s face in adoration; the way her eyelids flutter and fall closed when she cannot hold herself awake a minute

longer. Her entire body relaxes and her face softness and the second she sighs deeply that is where Adora knows she has fallen asleep completely, diving inside gentle dreams.

It´s been a good month, a good couple of months for Catra. It has been such a long time since Catra had a nightmare, a night terror. A long time since she woke up sweating and screaming, trashing in bed and kicking at invisible forces as Adora held her inside her arms. Since she would wake up with tears streaming down her face and her breath tangled with a scream as she would feel herself fall down against water.

Now there is only gentleness and Adora is there, always. Always back from the sea to hold Catra while she sleeps.

Adora does not really sleep much that night. She rests her cheek between the pillow and her own feathers and veils for Catra´s sleep like she used to do since she came back, night after night no matter where or when.

The nebulas in Adora´s eyes and wings reflect in Catra´s sleepy cheeks, painting her in ethereal colors while she sleeps. Her breathing pattern is very slow, cadent, testimony of gentle dreams. Her hair curls below her chin and she sleeps peacefully, her hands curled around Adora´s body and feathered scales, seeking for her even in her dreams.

Adora doesn´t really know when she starts crying but by the time she realizes there are already tears dripping down her cheeks, falling from sky like eyes and leaving paths in her face like rivers. They fall as pearls over the duvet and the pillows and tether gently down Catra´s collarbones where she nuzzles her body closer to Adora´s ethereal one, unaware of how much devotion it's being devoted to her.

Adora exhales, releasing the breath inside her lungs slowly, quiet enough that she doesn´t break into a sob that might wake up her lover. The tears are still there increasing, falling heavier down her face but Adora doesn´t stop them. She lets them flow, cold and

quiet. Good, it is good that they are out but it still aches in her bones, they burn and they drown her so she lets them out.

She runs her fingertips across Catra´s face, over her eyebrows all the way across the arch and down her temples, caressing the opal scar crossing the bridge of her nose. Down her cheekbones and the swell of her cheeks, the sharp angle of her jaw and the goosebump skin of her neck. Across half opened lips and the warm breath coming off them, tangling sharp nails over the loops of her hair, bouncing soft against her skin, every single day longer than the last.

It's been so long already but still feels like it just happened. Her life is good, Adora´s life is happy and quiet and loud and joyful but tonight it's heavy. It's been so long, it happened so long ago but it still weighs over her. What a beautiful thing it is to love and how sorrowful it is to carry with past pain.

Adora wraps Catra´s entire sleeping body inside her arms and brings her flush against her chest, holding her through the whole night, hearing her breath, hearing her beat. She has held her before like this, bloodied and broken and barely alive. Adora needs her to breathe against her cheeks right now.

Adora will not sleep tonight, she will remain here, ethereal and ocean made, humming a song, weaving it through Catra´s dreams. It´s anatomy, they are half of each other.

Their home is warm, ocean blessed, peach smell. It is a good life, a quiet life. But just for tonight, the cliff outside looms its shadow grip around Adora´s heart.

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The town´s market has become a habit, an every week event, another constant in Adora´s life, one more part of a life that she loves and that loves her in return.

It has grown in size from what she met more than a year ago, filled with colors, smells and sounds she had never seen before. Now it's familiar and with familiarity has come change and with change has come something better.

Mr and Mrs Thaymor are still placed right next to the bread stall with the wives that always wave Adora and Catra hello and goodbye. There are kids running in and around, chasing each other around the bushes and eating tangerines and peaches on the floor covered in grass and white sand. There are families and couples and friends, most of the time walking in separately and leaving together, sitting to each other or just talking pleasantly in the stalls, exchanging stories and laughing at each other´s jokes.

It is bigger than before, so much bigger, from one side of the main street and all the way to the square, filled with cheese and fruits and handmade trinkets, finishing in the limits of the shore, where the pebbles meet the everlasting blue water. Now that winter is coming to an end, the people linger just a little bit longer in the streets, enjoying the rays of the missed sun and dipping their toes in the water.

Adora and Catra don´t really know how it happened exactly but they know one day they sauntered here with baskets filled to the brim with fruits and vegetables from their garden and their greenhouse and they started giving them away to friends and acquaintances. They do not need money so it is an act of kindness, of belonging to a town, talking to people that helped rebuild their home and giving them something tender in return.

At some point, their walks down the square became sitting next to the fountain and giving strawberries to the kids and sharing Catra ´s baking with everybody that walked by and at some point someone pulled a table for them and suddenly they had a stall all of their own. They still don´t charge for any of it and Catra refuses to accept anything money related but she will never say no to strawberry cake and bright trinkets she knows Adora will love.

Once again it is a lovely day in Adora´s lovely life. Catra is leaning on her place next to her, handing a little girl a strawberry pastry and a cone of ice cream, seeing her talking to the baby girl in such a tender voice that Adora almost breaks down into tears again.

Adora braided seaglass and tiny shells in Catra´s hair this morning and now they twinkle with each other every time she moves, adorning her dark hair in ocean love. Catra´s shoulders are bare below the thin straps of her top and she is laughing, waving goodbye as the little girl skips on the stone floor of the square. Catra slips her hand inside Adora´s and squeezes, watching in silence at the town´s life walking them by.

It has been a quiet morning too, this one, and Catra has been lovely the whole time, always holding Adora´s hand. Absently, Adora realizes that she must not know, that she might have not realized what day is today. Because she is living a gentle life she deserves and dark oceans are long past her. Because it should not matter except that it does, for Adora it still does, so she holds herself to Catra´s warmth and rests her lips on the back of her shoulder blades, drinking in Catra´s giggles at the tickles.

"Catrina!" It is a woman of the town, older, small in her years and with her hair white. She has lived a good life and she has enjoyed growing old alongside it, smiling kindly at them.

Catra smiles back, tilting her head to the side with a sheepish look. "Hey, I got more of the tangerines you liked."

Adora is not really paying attention to the conversation. She is, in the fact that she is hearing the woman approach them and greet them, that she speaks to Catra in a gentle voice that reminds Adora to Razz and that whatever she says it makes Catra smile.

Instead, Adora plays with the small rips in Catra´s tights, pulling from the soft fabric and tickling the dark skin below. *It's fashionable* , Catra had said once, slipping into the hole-scattered

fabric with her hands over her hips, *I'm still the broody writer of this town.*

The fabric of Catra´s,Adora´s but today Catra´s, long pink skirt tangles a little in the buckles of her black shoes and it´s all endearing, the way ripped tights and dark boots are so natural with rose pink.

"How are the party plans coming along?" The old woman is asking, smiling brightly at Catra when the latter rolls her eyes and sighs, endearing more than truly annoyed.

"I have no idea." Catra confesses, shrugging. "Glimmer is dealing with all of that and I refuse to think about it"

"I get it. I still remember how stressful my wedding was." The woman nods, running her thumb softly over the golden band around her finger. "And I loved her more than anything but I would´ve rather eloped with her like you two did from the very beginning, than dealing with the logistics of a wedding."

Catra chuckles and says nothing, nuzzling closer into Adora´s hold. Adora however has gone slightly cold, her pale eyes locked into the golden band on the woman´s old finger.

She lost her wife, some years ago. They lived beautiful years together and they loved each other and Adora is sure neither of them would change anything of it no matter what, but the old woman still lost her. She is back on her own in this world, wandering without the woman she loved until the days also wear her away, be a few months or more years. Waiting,just waiting to be able to be with her again.

Adora digs her fingers a little bit tighter around Catra´s waist and holds her flush against her chest, her entire body growing cold even though Catra is warm as a sun.

"How long have you been married?"

“Almost two years.” Catra answers, easily. It spills off her mouth like the truth because that's what it is. “A few more months to go.”

“That´s beautiful.” The woman nods, smiling to herself.

The years of her life are written on her face, on the smile lines around her mouth and the wrinkles around her eyes when she laughs, quiet testimonies of a life filled with love.

She doesn´t even realize that the siren sitting quietly in front of her envies her, deeply. That Adora wants it too, the wrinkles and the old skin; the age freckles and the white hair. She wants it with Catra, she doesn´t know what she is going to do with herself if Catra leaves first.

The old woman and Catra speak for a few more minutes and then the first is also gone, walking in very slow steps across the seaside market with her basket hanging from her hang and her back bent by time.

Adora blinks back into reality by the feeling of Catra´s nose softly nuzzling the side of her cheek, kissing her way across Adora´s face and the straight fall of her nose bridge.

“Do you want to go home?” Catra asks against her ear, combing her fingers through the strands of hair on Adora´s nape.

Adora shivers under her touch, letting herself grow loose inside Catra´s arms. The fabric of Adora´s cotton dress is a little bit clammy from the heat of the day, sticking to her back and torso.

We can stay if you want, is Adora´s first train of thought, immediate and quickly in the base of her throat. Once upon a time she would have said them, because it's what she would have thought Catra wanted, not because Adora actually knew or wanted it back.

But Adora and Catra already made that mistake once. They have learned, they have grown in this year, learnt from their pain and

their mistakes. They are not the same people they were a year ago, and that's also good.

" *I do,"* Adora finally answers, signing sheepishly in front of their faces. " *I really want to go home."*

"Alright," Catra accepts immediately, stretching over Adora´s lap before stilling back, blinking very slowly at Adora. "I wanna go home too."

They pack up in silence, always right next to each other, their shoulders brushing every time one moves.

Their little sea town is changing around them, little by little and slowly. No, not changing, but adorning itself. There are gondolas on the port and pretty lamps being hung on the street lamps and the lines with colorful papers hung from wall to wall of the buildings.

The colors of the buildings are bright and beautiful, popping with their shades from turquoise blue to deep pinks to yellow, and it reminds Adora so much of the colorful colors of the depths of the sea that she has to hold her breath everytime she watches them, full of wonder for them.

There is life and peace inside this town, happiness, unfiltered joy. Even the harsh days seem to be watered down by the sounds of the waves washing over the white sands and the smooth pebbles. And even when it rains, drizzling over their heads and soaking through their clothes, Adora can always gaze at the sunlight on the horizon beyond the meadows.

People greet them as they walk by, nodding and smiling at them when they cross paths as if Adora and Catra had always existed in this place, from the very start. They wave at them from the windows and balconies of the shops and cheer at them when Catra wraps her arm around Adora´s waist a little tighter.

And when Adora looks at Catra skipping over whitened pebbles in the floor, she sees her so bright and smiling, her cheeks full and

her skin scattered by sun freckles, shimmering like the opals dug on her skin. She is wearing light clothes, and golden earrings; bracelets with tiny mother pearl cloves on her wrists and the everlasting rope around her finger, a forever kind of wedding ring that has survived everything.

Like the town, she is also different. Brighter, more colorful, more alive. Pretty like a tulip bloom and sea smelling.

Adora lowers her hand and reaches for Catra´s, tangling their fingers together, holding herself to her as they walk downtown together. It´s a really beautiful day, golden, bright as the sun hovering above their heads. And the sea is a beautiful shade of blue too, reflecting the sky above, mirroring Adora´s eyes too.

They have such a mundane life now, so ordinary. Adora thinks this as they make the journey back home, looking at the high meadows all around her and the change of scenery that goes from the town to their little bay on the seaside.

Catra always drives them around in their old car and every single time she sings with the windows rolled down, letting the warm breeze ruffle both of their hair behind them. They go to the markets and the shops and the local cinemas, they take long walks down the streets and greet their neighbors.

As they park in front of their home, built again, new but also old, more beautiful than ever, Adora thinks about the days painting the wooden window frames and about the newly done windchimes with sea glass, not only brought by Adora but also, sometimes, by Adam too. Begrudgingly but full of honesty.

As they step together on the porch, undoing the buckles and laces of their shoes, Adora thinks about the floors and the mosaics of the kitchen. About the windows with stained glass and the ugly carpets and the floral wallpaper in the corridors. The lit lamps washing warmth light inside and the old radio playing music in the living room.

Adora thinks about the days of cleaning and the days of repairing things that have broken down around the house; or the times they have brought something new for their home until it all looked like a sea cave full of treasures; like a ship, adrift in the middle of the sea, carrying within jewels and precious objects, all in the palm of Adora´s hands.

Catra skips her way inside and towards the kitchen, immediately grabbing a piece of cake from the fridge and Adora thinks about groceries day and about cooking nights and pizza and ice cream and cake, and all of those sour and sweet things Adora would have never knew if she hadn´t lived what they did, together.

When they are alone at their home Catra writes and sometimes she reads the paragraphs out loud for Adora to listen, glad to be heard, not writing to the emptiness anymore; Adora knows it makes her happy. There are books spilled on the bookcases and on the tables, avidly written by Catra, avidly read by Adora who is still trying to drink in the knowledge of it all. Of this world, whole, just as it is.

There are tulle and satin and silk fabrics scattered across the living room and the spare room. Pearls and opals fallen somewhere below the couches when the jar accidentally fell during a night waltzing to music and to themselves; and glitter on the fabrics, never washed away no matter how hard Catra tried.

It fixes something, the white sight, something Adora has not been able to forget. It fills the memories of scratch marks and broken skin with white glimmer and hopeful whispers, golden scissors cutting and clips holding the back of the dresses where they have tried their wedding gowns, together and on their own too. gentle sewn and carefully repaired.

If Adora were to rush the steps of the dark wooden stairs to the higher level, she would be able to walk past their shared room, blue and tender and sacred, and dance inside the spare one. She would be able to gaze at the twin mannequins patiently waiting

for them in front of the securely closed windows, the fabrics of both trails mingling together over the floor.

Adora would be able to see Catra´s dress, her mother's dress, repaired after fire and brought back to life, sewn with pearls and covered by the juliet veil. She would be able to see her own dress, covered too by the cathedral fall of the veils, simple, tender, so much like Catra´s white smile that makes Adora´s head spin.

But Adora doesn´t go now, it´s not time yet, soon but not just yet. She is needed here, today, tonight, she stays here on the ground and not floating in the clouds.

Adora plays the piano for Catra, tonight and almost every day. It has become a routine for them, as many things recently have. Catra takes off her thighs and Adora´s socks and she swirls around on her bare feet over the newly polished wood of the floor, smiling to herself at the sound of Adora´s fingers rushing through the piano keys into such a beautiful music that Catra can´t do anything else but to throw her head back and laugh out loud at the wander her life has become into.

They play with Melog and tend to their garden and their greenhouse and their sea, blessed from all cardinal points so their home is safe. By the meadows and the sand and the shore…. and…. and….

Even as a siren, even as a creature of the sea, they have created such a quiet life that it catches Adora by surprise every once in a while how much she loves it.

Adora is sitting cross legged on the floor of the corridor, barefoot and with the skirt of her dress tangled around her legs as she looks up at Catra moving left and right on one of the coffee tables they have laying around. Catra is humming under her breath, cutting tiny dry twigs from a bouquet of flowers they had brought from the market.

Recently there have been a lot of flowers inside their home. They have all arrived little by little, wrapped in wax paper and delivered at their home or in the town; all of them in gentle preparation for next week.

Roses and tiny daisies and freesias and anemones. Those last are Adora´s favorites because they are so different from the anemones she grew up playing around inside the vast sea but just as beautiful, white and purple heart and beautiful, the stems curling around themselves on Catra´s fingers.

Adora knows, as much as Catra is trying to convince everyone that she doesn´t want to get involved or that the preparations annoy her, that she is excited. Incredibly so. In fact, Adora is sure she is over the moon.

Adora has seen her prepare lemon cupcakes for three weeks straight until she was happy with it for their own wedding cake; and Adora has been happily enjoying eating the fruits of her preparations every day too. She has seen Catra wandering towards the spare room more than twice before slipping into bed, and has been hearing her singing under her breath, happily, excited.

She is not annoyed, or over it, or anxious over the party. Catra is *happy,* and it is turning Adora´s world completely on its axis.

Adora is happy too, she is so happy that it doesn´t fit inside her chest. Joy is overflowing from her chest and pouring inside her throat and through her open lips and towards the world. Adora is so happy right now that she doesn´t know what to do with herself but to sit here and gaze upon the woman she loves more than life itself, more than the sea.

Maybe this is the reason why she says it. Because it´s a friday, not a sunday, and today at this exact hour a year ago the sky outside was not gentle blue and orange but virulent violet and Adora was nos sitting bare feet on the floor of her home but on the sea, swimming violently and not fast enough.

Because a year ago Catra was not singing under her breath and pruning flowers but falling, falling, *falling,* and they are getting married next Sunday and Adora cannot forget. And she is scared.

"It was today." These are the first words Adora speaks in days.

Catra turns around to meet her eyes, still smiling, still holding a flower in her hand. Her hair reaches her chin and her scars shimmer.

"What sweetheart?"

"You fell today"

Silence drops between them, not heavy but still, quiet like a feather fallen in tranquil waters. Catra gazes at Adora with her eyes slightly widened. With the days, her beauty has not faded but has grown stronger, gentle for Adora´s eyes to see.

"Oh," Catra gasps, lowering her hands. "Oh"

There are a thousand thoughts going on inside her eyes, Adora can see them all almost all too well. Surprise, yes, shock. Then, comprehension followed by an immediate sense of grief, of sorrow, coated in resignation.

Adora shuffles on the floor, looking down from Catra´s sorrowful face to her skin, pooled over Adora´s lap like a blanket. pulling from the blue pearls with her nails.

"I knew, since the other day and I didn't want to make a big deal of it but—" Adora chokes with her breath. She feels the sting of tears immediately gathering in the corner of her eyes and she closes her eyes tight until she sees sparks, fighting them back.

In front of her Catra shifts on her feet, giving a few steps closer but still standing.

"You can tell me." Catra´s voice sounds so calm, so different from the storm swirling inside Adora´s chest.

Adora opens her eyes and allows herself to look back at her, gathering all of Catra inside her irises. Her bare soles too, the arch of her feet; the wide of her calves, the gentle fall of her legs. The divot of her hips below the fabric of her shorts and the curve of her abdomen peeking from the hem of her green tank top.

Adora´s eyes roam a little longer there, on the sweet roll of her waist and the swell of her breasts; the freckles scattered over her stronger upper arms and the clove bracelets around her wrists. Her cheeks are fuller, rosier, and her skin is healthier, soft like butter where the opals don´t cross it.

It's endearing and sweet all at the same time, rich like summer marshes and cake at unholy hours of the morning.

"I saw you put on some weight." Adora cringes a little under the weight of her own words, scared they might be taken incorrectly. When she looks at Catra´s mismatched eyes all she sees is profound comprehension. "I´ve been— I´ve been seeing you lately and I— I saw you *eat* and I saw you laugh and dance and sing. And I– you´re healthy, you´re, Cat—"

A year ago, Adora was able to count Catra's ribs with her fingertips. All of them. All the depth and crevices of her spine were in sight to see, her legs thin and her collarbone deep. A year ago her cheeks were shallow and her skin grayish and she looked half dead. She almost died, all over the old floor of their old home, over this land, inside that very same sea that today is calm.

A year ago Adora saw Catra falling from the sky, falling from the cliff and sauntering towards the ground like a feather falling into a pillow, like a flower over violent waters. And they talked about it, and Catra healed from it, slowly too, and so did Adora, but the memory was still there, forever etched to her brain.

And even after all of it happened, after seven days of sorrow and the night that came after, there was still so much pain to go through. The weeks and months that came after were kind but

they were also difficult, for both of them. Sad, painful, filled with long nights and poor appetite, with untouched food on plates and worried embraces.

Today Adora can see the small divots on the low of her back, like smiles all of their own. Today there are thunderbolts in Catra's thighs and tender rolls in her abdomen when she sits or curls in bed. There is softened skin beneath Adora's mouth when she kisses Catra's belly and hips, and gentle curves like waves in her arms.

Today there is sweetness and wedding gifts and peace, and Adora needs just a second tonight to let the past go before her life keeps moving forwards.

“Love,” Catra calls, falling to her knees in front of Adora. Adora hiccups not even noticing that she had started crying until the tears were rolling down her cheekbones.

“I´m just— I love you so much,” Adora mumbles, smiling through her tears. “Catra—”

“I'm here.” Catra wraps her arms around Adora´s neck and the back of her head, resting Adora´s forehead over her own chest. “I'm here”

Adora wraps her arms around Catra´s waist too and holds her as close as she can to her, nuzzling her face against her collarbones. She is not crying anymore, not heavily, errand tears still rolling down the curve of her cheekbones. But she needs it, the touch, the embrace, they both do.

Catra gathers Adora completely inside her arms, catching her sadness in her palms. She shifts her legs beneath them and cradles Adora over her lap, resting Adora´s long legs over her thighs and nestling Adora´s back and head over her shoulder.

It´s sweet, extremely gentle, it reminds Adora of the first night she arrived home, wrapped up in human clothes and nervously eating steaming noodles next to Catra´s soaked form.

" *I missed you so much,"* Adora signs in the space between them, unable to express all she wants to say with voice alone. *"Every single day, I missed you, I almost died without you. Sometimes I see you and I wonder how could I ever dare leave you? How could I? What kind of madness made me let go of your hand? And I can´t—"*

Catra rests her gentle hand over Adora´s, reassuring her nervous hands with her warm palm. She then moves her hand up, cradling Adora´s chin with her fingers.

"I got you," Catra signs, grinning. She is crying too, quietly. *"And you got me"*

"You are the love of my life." Adora hiccups, her bangs brushing over the skin of her nose bridge. *"I´m sorry"*

"You found me again. And you have never let go from my hand since then." Catra whispers, resting her hand over Adora´s fluttering heart. "You kept your promise"

Adora´s chin wobbles with the rush of newfound tears, wrapping her fingers around Catra´s wrist to keep her close.

"And next week, hey look at me pretty siren, next week we are going to get married," Catra grins, bright and damp like the dawn ´s sun over the sea. "The human way"

Adora laughs through tears too, nodding. She nuzzles her face against the angle of Catra´s neck and breathes on the smell of her skin, sighing. Over her lap, her skin starts to melt, soaking over her human skin and transforming her again.

Catra doesn´t flinch against the change, running the pads of her fingers across Adora´s crystal ears and the silk soft membranes of her gills. it tickles when she does so and, like every single time Adora is feeling so much so fast, her soft ears start flapping like dragonfly ears, brushing below Catra´s nose.

“I like when they do that,” Catra whispers around a giggle, resting her palms over the opals and turquoise scattered across the small of Adora´s waist. “We survived, Adora, we are here now”

“**I know**,”Adora whispers, her siren voice slipping with the human one.

“None of us chose what happened with Prime, with the accident, with his choices, it was not on us. And for the choices that we did take and that hurt both of us, we have already atone for it, more than enough. We survived, we are together, we deserve this life Adora. You taught me that too.”

Adora breathes deeply through her gills, the feathers on her head closing softly around Catra´s face. “You are not scared of the cliff anymore?”

Adora doesn´t only mean the fall from the cliff with her question. Catra knows it too.

“I am, sometimes more than others, sometimes much less.” Catra kisses Adora´s forehead, resting her cheek over her seaweed and silk hair. “I don´t know if we are ever going to not be scared of the past, Dora, but we can focus on learning how to live this new life. We have all the time in the world.”

“Do we?”

“Yes we do,” Adora can feel Catra smile against her scales. “I really do think being loved by a siren must be a really strong blessing for me.”

Adora starts sobbing again and Catra joins her silently, rocking them both reassuringly from side to side. A night of tonight a year ago brought Catra so much pain and so much trauma, but she has raised above. It still hangs from her body like a phantom weight that every once in a while comes back, but she has learned how to fight it back with the amount of love in her life.

Love from their town, love from their people. Love from Adora, love for herself. She has *healed,* little by little and not completely, but she has. It´s in her heart and in her body.

Next to her, Adora thinks she can heal too. She knows she will. And maybe tonight will always be difficult, but they are here to hold each other.

“I love you Adora,” Catra chants, kissing Adora´s spiky cheek. “I love you so much.More than anything in the world.”

“I love you too.I adore you.” Adora whispers too, gathering Catra ´s body inside hers and not letting her go. “Sometimes it is hard. I know sometimes it's hard for you too.”

“It is”

“But I love you too, more than life.” Adora exhales, blinking through her tears, thinking of every single good thing that they have in their life right now. That is still to come. Walks on the town and seashells on the bay and slow dances and cake. “So much matters, but you are the most important of them all. I will stay forever for you.”

Catra chokes around a sob and nods, holding Adora close to her chest. It occurs to Adora then, not for the first time, that she is not the only one afraid of losing the other. That she is not the only one eager to live this life and so sorrowful of living it too fast.

“I´m sorry,” Adora apologizes again because she doesn´t know what else to do.

“Don´t apologize, not for this. You will break, I will break down too. We both will and we will both hold onto each other.” This time, Catra is the one that nuzzles on the crook of Adora´s neck, breathing off her skin. “But you won´t see me fall again.”

“You promise?”

“I promise.” Catra takes a shivering breath. “You will always be there, to hold my hand on the edge.”

“Of course I will,” Adora reassures immediately. “I promise”

“Okay,” Catra smiles, running her thumb over the hollow of Adora´s neck. “Then we will be okay”

The radio is still playing in the kitchen and the flowers are still resting on the counter. Melog is peacefully sleeping on the resthold of the couch and it´s drizzling outside, hitting over the white sand and colorful windows gently.

Adora holds Catra with all her strength and Catra holds her right back, still a siren and a human, a curious thing and a writer in love with the curious, like a year before and like the years that are to come still. Somehow, the weight of the cliff outside is not as overwhelming tonight, not anymore.

Adora´s stomach grumbles accidentally at some point, even in her siren form, echoing between them. Catra huffed and snorts a laugh, poking Adora in the middle of her shimmering forehead.

“Hungry?” She teases, her face full of life.

Adora flushes too, a deep shade of blue only rivaled by the sea outside. “A little bit.”

“Do you want cake?”

“I always want cake”

“Good,” Catra chuckles, caressing Adora´s scars over her skin and making them tender with her touch. “Because we´ll have plenty next week”

Catra helps Adora on her feet, still impossible tall and fully siren, hovering above her head like a sea spirit that had stumbled inside, all feathers and shimmering colors. It´s kind of funny, how even this cryptic moment between them is more tender and domestic

than anything else. So ordinary that it doesn´t feel strange and it doesn´t ache.

Adora catches Catra looking at her sideways, her face red and full of amazement but also with a small glint in cheekiness on it that it calls Adora´s attention completely, making her trip a little on ethereal feet.

“What are you thinking?”

Catra´s smile widens, huge and beautiful from ear to ear, popping the divots on her cheeks.

“I knew you were thinking my butt looks great lately. I´ve caught you staring at it a lot, y´know?”

Adora´s huge mouth falls open, her jaw growing slack, shark teeth and all, all of her feathers ruffling immediately like a frizzled bird.

“Listen—”

“I can´t blame you,” Catra presses on, resting her hands over her own wide hips, gripping the soft flesh there. “I *am* getting very hot.”

“Alright you.” Adora shrinks down, still partially the siren form, scales and opals on her temples like crowns and her skin like silk dress, but smaller. Just enough so she can bend down and wrap her arms around Catra's waist, carrying her over her shoulder. “Come here”

Catra laughs out loud like a maniac, giggling and kicking her feet as Adora carries her across their home, dripping pearls and shimmering scales across the corridors.

Catra doesn't say it but she has noticed it too, the change in herself. She has stood in front of the mirror of their bedroom or stared through the windows of the shops, and seen herself anew in this skin.

The scars that once frightened are now beacons of light for her, traces of the love of her life carried on her own body. She sees herself softer too, gentler too. Still the old herself but also new, less sharp edges and frightfully thin wrists. More golden, warmer, as if a little of the sun´s light had slipped beneath her skin too, scattering her with more freckles.

Pretty, Catra looks at herself and she sees herself beautiful and she is happy for it.

She knows she still has a long time to go,but Adora is right. Catra has started to heal, truly, they both have. What a better moment is there for them to marry but this one?

—— ⋆·☆·⋆ ——

Catra stands on the highest point of the cliff, her bare feet digging on the soft earth inches away from the edge.

The dawn is warm, the night sky retreating from the waking world, mingling its blue colors with the pinks and goldens of the rising sun. Below the high cliff, the sea is full of energy, calmer now that the moon has gone to sleep but still shivering, its tall, *tall* waves embracing the whitened stone of the cliff like salt kisses, wrapping sea foam arms around the cliff´s feet and retreating again into a dance full of sounds.

Catra looks at the water and wonders, just for an instant, if she too would have transformed into sea foam. If her body would have dissolved among shells and coral and had turned her into something moving too, a part of the ocean too, living and breathing from the waves like the old tale, amber and blue until she was also a part of the sea that she so much had learnt to love and that had loved her in return.

Now that her life has found peace like the ocean too, she thinks it would not be so bad. In the future, when her time comes, she would like to meet the sea as equals. After all, this very same

ocean had gifted Catra of what she loves the most, of the best part of her life.

She wants to be her friend and her daughter too, like her own mother, who also became sea foam all on her own. Catra thinks it would be peaceful, being carried on the waves.

Catra exhales and looks past her feet, at the downbelow, past pebbles and moss and the edge, and she finds in herself that her heart remains calm.

There are memories swirling inside her head, of course, reminders of what happened to her in this very same place, when the ground was dry and no bloom grew, and she was dragged here as if this place wasn´t also a piece of her home.

If she closes her eyes, Catra can still feel the cold air swirling the strands of her hair, the stones digging on her soles and knees and the rush of the cliff´s height against her body. But… It feels different now, less real, so much more like a photograph soaked into water.

Catra is sure now that little by little, as the years pass her by, the memories will become fuzzier, still present but only when she wants them to. Something she survived, like Weaver´s foster home and her mother´s death. Something stuck in a piece of paper but not on stone.

Catra´s body nor life is on the line anymore, neither is the person she loves. She can stand on this edge and gaze at the horizon and breath.

A body approaches her, all pearls and opals and white. The fabric of Adora´s wedding dress tangles around her human legs and the breeze ruffles the golden strands of her hair when she approaches, taking slow but sure steps towards the spot Catra is standing in.

Catra tilts her head sideways towards her and smiles, stretching her hand forwards and hoping Adora will take it. As always, she

does.

Their hairs are in a little bit of disarray and both of their dresses are wrinkled after a full evening and night of dancing. Of celebrating and dancing and laughing together and with others, their soles sore from waltzing and their throats tired from smiling.

There are flower petals still stuck to Adora´s loose hair, confetti and sparkles on both of theirs, matching the bundle of flowers still held softly in Catra´s other hand. Cottons and anemones, bluebells and laurel and lavenders.

Adora holds Catra´s hand inside hers and leans down, pressing a kiss over her knuckles right below the gentlerope of Catra´s ring, as steady as always.

Catra giggles at the brush of lips and raises on her tippy toes, placing a kiss over the bridge of Adora´s nose. She runs her fingers over the delicate golden flowers of the necklace placed around Adora´s neck, a wedding present from their friends, and smiles against her mouth, giggling when Adora hums a siren song for her in return.

Catra is so grateful, so deeply happy right now, with the traces of exhaustion from their wedding and the warm sea breeze, that she cannot help but to giggle against Adora´s mouth, her smile bright when Adora bends down a little and wraps her arms around her waist to hold her closer as they kiss.

Catra is twenty eight now. And as much as her life was hard in the beginning and the middle, as much as she always thought she would be alright never falling in love nor being loved in return, Catra knows deep within herself that she has been waiting for this her entire life,

Thank god it´s you, Catra thinks, resting her cheeks against Adora´s, embracing her close. *Thank god for you. I´m not scared anymore..*

Adora sings softly next to her, running her hands over Catra´s shoulders and down the opening of her dress across her back, following the path of tiny pearls sewn to the fabric and the length of her veil. Adora is smiling but Catra can see the way Adora´s pale blue eyes flicker towards the cliff and the horizon, her glazing over a little.

This is the first time either of them set foot in this place since last night. The first time, not the last; they are reclaiming this back too, for themselves, for their home and their family to come. This is theirs, their own, no longer gray and dry but covered in evergreen grass and daffodil blooms.

Catra tangles her fingers with Adora´s and turns her head around too, gazing at the edge and infinite sea below. Deep beneath her bones and her flesh she knows. She is not scared anymore.

Catra leans down and leaves her wedding bouquet on the ground, the gentle flowers a striking white against the green floor. She knows they will not root, but then again maybe they will. Maybe they will grow roots and stems here and make the cliff flourish even more.

Catra feels Adora´s hands cradling her face and tilting her head back towards her, looking at Catra as if all of the ocean´s waves had made a home inside her eyes.

“I love you so much,” Adora whispers in her mother tongue, smiling through warm tears. Catra smiles right back, caressing the skin below Adora´s pale eyes.

“I love you too.”

From this place on the cliff, Catra can see the blue roof of their house, the open windows and periwinkle curtains, all those little knickers and tiny things that make them their own. If Catra pays a little bit of attention, she thinks she can still hear the music coming from their town.

Catra sighs, over the cliff, hand in hand with Adora´s life.

“Let's go home, my beautiful beautiful wife.”

—— ⋆·☆·⋆ ——

They may not remember me, but golly it was unforgettable.

They don’t remember me but I remember their faces, their names.

How they sound and writhe under my touch.

They brought an experience so profound, my, not even my own stardom could even touch it.

Oh, how I miss them. May their stars rain **.**

—@**Dori_Le_Fishy**

End Notes

Hope you liked it! Kudos, bookmarks, suscriptions, shares and comments are deeply appreciated. Until the waves meets us again, be good!

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